

Chapter 185 Part 1: Extra Story 8-1

Mumu did go to school and apologize to that child.

The other parent also listened to their own child's wishes and continued letting the child sit with Mumu as desk mates.

Meanwhile, Chaochao was arranged to sit at the other end of the classroom, almost diagonally opposite.

Chaochao and Mumu were separated at kindergarten—they didn't even sit together during lunch.

Usually, Mumu would always say she hated her sister, but after being separated for one day, as soon as school let out, she would hold onto Chaochao's hand tightly and not let go.

It was the height of summer, the weather so hot that people wished they could dive into a refrigerator and roll around. Yet Mumu insisted on holding onto Chaochao with her sweaty, clammy hands. Chaochao struggled several times to no avail.

Once they got in the car with air conditioning, Chaochao immediately found wet wipes to clean her hands.

That day, Xu Qingzhu came to pick them up. Liang Shi had an interview and didn't have time to come.

Actually, they should have asked the housekeeper to come, but Xu Qingzhu liked to personally handle matters concerning these two children. Since kindergarten let out early, Xu Qingzhu would pick them up and go to the company first, letting them sit in the office to do homework or draw. She and Liang Shi were also planning to send them to interest classes they liked once the two little ones were a bit older.

Xu Qingzhu saw Chaochao wiping her hands with a frown and asked her what was wrong.

Chaochao looked up, "Mommy, little sister is clingy."

Mumu: ".....Hmph, mean sister."

Xu Qingzhu laughed at this and didn't bother with them anymore, letting them bicker in the back seat.

The two little ones bickering was also quite funny, though Chaochao wasn't good with words and always ended up at a disadvantage.

Mumu—who knew who she took after—always had so much to say when arguing, and spoke quickly too. Chaochao was no match for her at all.

Chaochao wasn't good at arguing and would only sulk in silence.

After the bickering ended, having lost, she sat in the corner of the car and ignored Mumu.

Mumu then went to coax her in that irksome way of hers, "Jiejie~"

Chaochao lowered her head to read a book.

By the time Xu Qingzhu brought them to the company, Mumu still hadn't successfully coaxed Chaochao.

Chaochao stood there very coolly, while Mumu followed behind her like a little tail.

It wasn't until they entered the office that Mumu flopped onto the sofa and said tiredly: "Jiejie, you're so hard to coax."

Chaochao said quietly: "I didn't ask you to coax me."

Mumu: "....."

So Mumu really stopped trying to coax her.

By dinnertime, Chaochao was still ignoring her.

Mumu put her favorite beef into Chaochao's bowl. Chaochao pushed it aside and lowered her head to eat.

Mumu pouted aggrievedly and looked toward Liang Shi.

Liang Shi had long known what happened between them on the way, so she pretended not to see Mumu's distress signal.

Xu Qingzhu did the same.

Left without any support, Mumu lowered her head and picked at her rice, finding it as tasteless as wax.

Before bed, Mumu lay unhappily on the bed, not even close to Chaochao.

The little sister who wasn't clinging to Chaochao seemed especially well-behaved, but also especially dejected.

Both Liang Shi and Xu Qingzhu wanted to see how the two of them would handle their sisterly issues, so neither intervened this time.

In the past when things like this occasionally happened, Xu Qingzhu or Liang Shi would subconsciously ask the sensible Chaochao to yield to her little sister, not to argue with her or to forgive first.

But they were already kindergarteners now. Xu Qingzhu and Liang Shi had both realized that always making Chaochao yield to Mumu would make Chaochao's personality become more and more withdrawn. So they didn't interfere in conflicts between the two, wanting to see how Chaochao would handle it.

It was also because Liang Shi had coincidentally run into Zhou Li, who had returned to visit family, and she said that Rainbow had been withdrawn as a child because she had been too strict.

So she advised Liang Shi not to be too strict with children.

Especially in a twin family like this—even though one was called the older sister, she had only come into this world a few seconds before her younger sister. It wasn't fair for either one to always yield to the other.

Smart children were especially sensitive to these things.

After discussing with Xu Qingzhu, they both felt they should proactively talk to Chaochao, hoping she could be happy.

Both of them were first-time mothers and didn't know what was best.

The biggest problem with raising children was that you had to feel your way across the river the whole time.¹ There was never a perfect textbook, nor a perfect template.

That night before bed, Xu Qingzhu secretly went to the two children's room. She had originally intended to go in and see if they were asleep, but then she heard Chaochao say slowly: "I don't hate you."

Mumu choked out: "You keep ignoring me~"

Chaochao said in a muffled voice: "Don't argue with me in the future. I can't win against you."

Mumu: "Okay~"

Chaochao: "Alright, let's sleep."

Mumu: "I want to hold hands~"

Chaochao: "Childish."

Mumu: ".....Jiejie."

Chaochao must have reached her hand over, "Scaredy-cat."

Mumu didn't argue back, changing from crying to laughing: "Jiejie is the best."

Xu Qingzhu returned to the room satisfied, lying there discussing with Liang Shi about who Mumu's mischievously clever nature took after.

After discussing back and forth, they both felt it might be like their little aunt, that little demon king Sheng Yu.

However, the little demon king was only ten years old now.

Even in elementary school, she was still that fiery little demon king.

But Liang Shi smiled: "She might also take after me."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Did she have some misunderstanding about Liang Shi?

Liang Shi winked at her, suddenly raised her hand, and mimicking Mumu's usual manner, waved it down, "Meow~"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu's smile suddenly grew wider. She leaned forward and fell into her arms, laughing until she was shaking uncontrollably.

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1. "摸着石头过河" (mō zhe shí tou guò hé) is a Chinese idiom meaning "crossing the river by feeling the stones," describing a cautious approach to an unfamiliar situation through trial and error. ⇐

Chapter 185 Part 2: Extra Story 8-2

In the blink of an eye, Chaochao and Mumu were already in high school.

The two little ones had grown into graceful young ladies.

Chaochao was still quiet, and Mumu was still mischievously clever as ever.

Likewise, Chaochao's grades were exceptionally good, while Mumu struggled a bit.

It wasn't that Mumu wasn't smart—on the contrary, every time at parent-teacher conferences, the teacher would tell Liang Shi that their Mumu was very smart, just that she couldn't concentrate and always liked to fidget during class.

The scariest part was that in her third year of high school, the teacher told Liang Shi: "Shen Xuan seems to be in a relationship."

Liang Shi: "?"

A crisis called "child's puppy love" suddenly erupted at home.

Liang Shi spent the day with complicated feelings, and it wasn't until that night before bed that she tentatively told Xu Qingzhu about it.

Xu Qingzhu was rather open-minded about it. After hearing it, she just said "oh" and didn't express any opinion.

Finally, Liang Shi couldn't sit still. After struggling with herself several times, she still got up, "No, I have to go ask Chaochao."

"Do you think Chaochao would tell you?" Xu Qingzhu put down her skincare products and looked up at her.

Liang Shi: "....."

If Chaochao told, Liang Shi would be turning Chaochao into a traitor.

That wouldn't be good for the sisters' relationship.

But if she didn't ask, Liang Shi felt she wouldn't be able to eat or sleep peacefully for days.

She stood there torn and hesitant, her brow furrowed into little mountains. Xu Qingzhu sat in front of the vanity, chin resting on her palm, watching her at leisure.

Her gaze finally pulled Liang Shi out of the matter of Mumu's puppy love, and she asked curiously: "What is it?"

"Teacher Liang, I really didn't misjudge you back then." Xu Qingzhu shook her head to herself and stood up, speaking mysteriously.

Liang Shi: "?"

"You really are a daughter slave." Xu Qingzhu said lightly, getting into bed to lie down. "Shen Xuan is already seventeen, she's about to be an adult. Isn't it normal to have these signs?"

"She's still a minor! She hasn't even taken the college entrance exam yet!" Liang Shi said indignantly: "How is that normal?"

"Can you even control it? A teenage girl's innocent little thoughts during puberty—can you control that?" Xu Qingzhu said: "Either pretend you don't know, or hint to her indirectly to focus on studying first. Stop pacing around here, you're making me dizzy."

Liang Shi: "....."

A few minutes later, Liang Shi suddenly sat on the edge of the bed looking aggrieved, looking at her: "You're annoyed with me."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"No, I'm not." Xu Qingzhu blinked. She still had a short video app open on her phone, and after finishing talking to Liang Shi, she continued looking down at her phone.

Liang Shi looked at the pretty girl on her screen, her expression darkening.

After another two minutes of silence, Xu Qingzhu finally deigned to close her phone.

But Liang Shi was already angry.

Liang Shi didn't even care about Shen Xuan's matter anymore. She went over and picked up her pillow.

Xu Qingzhu grabbed her hem, "Where are you going?"

Liang Shi: "To the guest room."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

Xu Qingzhu didn't let go. Instead, she scooted closer to her, hugged her waist, and her hand happened to land on her waistline, giving it a feel.

"What are you doing?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu pursed her lips, suddenly lifted the hem of her pajamas, and kissed her lower abdomen.

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi's ears suddenly turned red, and she said another wooden sentence: "What are you doing?"

But obviously, her second sentence was much more tender than before.

"Kissing you." Xu Qingzhu looked up: "Is that not allowed?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"I'm angry right now." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "I know, isn't this me coaxing you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu's words flowed so smoothly that Liang Shi couldn't refute them for a moment, and didn't even know what to say next.

She just couldn't stay angry.

If Liang Shi got angry, Xu Qingzhu always had a hundred ways to make her stop being angry.

Liang Shi touched her hair, "You can't coax me tonight."

Xu Qingzhu pursed her lips and kissed a bit higher, "Can I coax you or not?"

Liang Shi's toes curled up from what she was doing. Not wanting to lose face in front of her, she immediately put the pillow between them, "I'm going to sleep in the guest room."

Xu Qingzhu narrowed her eyes slightly, "Fine, go ahead."

Liang Shi: "?"

Not even going to coax her anymore?

Liang Shi lifted her foot to leave, but Xu Qingzhu suddenly lay back on the bed, saying with an aggrieved expression: "You're going to sleep in separate rooms from me because of our daughter. Why did I even have children in the first place?"

It sounded like she was feeling sorry for herself.

But Liang Shi paused, "It's not because of Shen Xuan."

Xu Qingzhu asked: "Then why?"

The room was silent for a few seconds. Liang Shi suddenly turned around, rushed over in one stride, and pressed Xu Qingzhu directly onto the bed. Her hands tightly gripped her wrists as she said with grievance tinged with resentment: "Don't I have abs? You just have to look at someone else's."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Xu Qingzhu stared straight at her.

Liang Shi couldn't help it and kissed her on the lips, then smelled a very fresh scent. Her brow suddenly furrowed.

"Did you change your lip balm?" Liang Shi asked.

"Does it smell good?" Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow.

Liang Shi: ".....You used to say that because I like oranges, you always used orange-flavored lip balm."

The implication being—you've changed, you don't love me anymore.

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "I think I did say that."

Seeing Liang Shi's expression about to crack, Xu Qingzhu laughed and stopped teasing her: "Sister Hui gave it to me. I couldn't find my own just now so I used this one. Also, that person is a fitness blogger I followed before... I'm also planning to work on getting abs."

Liang Shi: "?"

Liang Shi was so frustrated by her that she leaned over and kissed her.

Almost as if to devour her whole.

After the long kiss ended, Xu Qingzhu asked lightly: "Baby, does my new lip balm taste good?"

Liang Shi didn't say anything, responding with action instead.